



AirPods don't fall out

Do Apple's AirPods leave you concerned if they could be lost easily? Here's what Tim Cook has to say. <http://digit.in/AirPdTC>



Logitech K780 at \$79.99

Logitech's K780 Wireless Keyboard supports typing on Windows, Mac, Android or iOS devices. <http://digit.in/LgtK780>

Smartphone test

THE WINNERS

Best Performer: OnePlus 3

If you've read all of the above, you'll have guessed that the OnePlus 3 is the out-and-out best performer amongst these phones. OnePlus has done a splendid job of marrying software with hardware, producing a phone that doesn't just look and feel premium, but can rival the most expensive flagships with its performance. It's fast, produces no lags, and can deal with the most resource intensive tasks without breaking a sweat.

Best Camera: OnePlus 3

As we mentioned earlier, the OnePlus 3 just barely



OnePlus 3

edges past the Zenfone 3 in this department. Its 16MP camera is really good at this price, and better details and sharpness earn it the best camera award. However, if you're buying in the sub-25k range, the Zenfone 3 is easily the best phone for those who can't do without a good camera.

In fact, the Zenfone 3 beats the OnePlus 3 in extreme low light condi-

tions. While this is an impractical situation, it's still worth giving the latter a few points for this.

Best Display: OnePlus 3

This is important for those who watch a lot of videos and movies on their phones. The OnePlus 3's display produces deeper blacks than the others, and is quite accurate with the colours as well. It's also a very premium display, and feels good to touch as well.

The Xiaomi Mi 5 is a close second, but its default bluish tint is somewhat disconcerting, and low brightness keeps it from being the best. It's still the best in the sub-25k segment, though.



ASUS Zenfone 3

Best Battery: ASUS Zenfone 3

None of the others can compete with the Zenfone 3 in the battery department. The phone's 3000 mAh battery lasts longer than a full day and it's a good pick for those who can't compromise on battery life. While the OnePlus 3 would also suit many users, the Zenfone 3 is considerably better than that device. 

HOW WE TESTED

This part's easy, and you probably know it too. However, for the uninitiated, here's how the process goes. We run benchmarks on the devices, to get an objective idea of how the processor within each of them perform. This is followed by real world tests, designed in the Digit test labs to test the performance of each device. We record the videos in the highest possible resolutions, taxing the processor enough. We then use heat guns to test the heat on the body. Internal heat is tested using benchmarks, and precisely mapped gaming and video recording, too.

For the camera, we take the same shots with all the devices, comparing them on a calibrated display, side-by-side. We take photos in myriad light conditions, ranging from bright sunlight to

extremely low, even unrealistic conditions. We also take into consideration the camera's features, for any added effects that they may add, or improvement in the overall image quality that may be possible by using them.

For the display, we use the HTC LX-101A Lux meter to test maximum brightness. This is done in a controlled environment, with no ambient light, so as to get the most accurate readings possible. Of course, auto brightness and other display features are turned off for this, so as to establish a common ground for all phones. The colours are judged using pre-chosen photos, and other calibrating tools.

Next up, we have tested the battery life on each of these phones using the Geekbench 3 battery test. It is worth noting that this test

is no longer available on Google Play, and we will be retiring it after this comparison. The battery life is also tested using looping video, real world usage, and predecided video recording and gaming times.

Once we have an objective view of what a phone's capabilities are, we try to put the same to practice in the real world. All discrepancies here are noted, and it figures into the final score.

It is also worth mentioning that build and design of smartphones are also taken into consideration. However, we're leaving that part out in this comparison, since a lot depends on personal choice amongst these four devices. You can always refer to the review published earlier, or on digit.in for more on that aspect of these devices if that is what you seek.